Office for Budget Responsibility

Log of substantive contact between the Office for Budget Responsibility and Ministers and their Special Advisers/Direct ministerial appointments and private office staff between 3 March 2026 and 27 October 2026

Date	Which Ministers, Offices or Special Advisers/Direct ministerial appointments?	Type of contact	Brief summary of discussion/purpose
20 July	Chancellor, Chancellor's office and other Treasury officials	Email	Note on the OBR's updated assessment of the outlook for the economy and public finances
27 July	Chancellor, Chancellor's office and other Treasury officials	Meeting	To discuss preparations for the Budget and forecast
3 September	Treasury officials, Direct ministerial appointment	Meeting	Analytical discussion
18 September	Chancellor, Chancellor's office and other Treasury officials	Email	Summary of the pre-measures forecast
22 September	Chancellor, Chancellor's office and other Treasury officials	Email	Note on the pre-measures forecast
2 October	Chancellor, Chancellor's office and other Treasury officials	Email	Note on the effect of policy measures on the economy and fiscal forecast
8 October	Chancellor, Chancellor's office and other Treasury officials	Meeting	To discuss preparations for the Budget and forecast
22 October	Treasury officials	Email	Advance pre-release draft of *Economic and fiscal outlook* (*EFO*) chapters
26 October	Treasury officials	Email	Final *EFO* document

Exceptional pre-release access list

The *Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)* between the Office for Budget Responsibility, HM Treasury, the Department for Work and Pensions and HM Revenue and Customs contains guidance on the scope and purpose of exceptional pre-release access to our documents. In accordance with those terms, the three lists below contain the 68 people who received the draft version (either in full or in part) of the October 2026 *Economic and fiscal outlook* on 26 February:

Ministers

Chancellor of the Exchequer

Minister for Pensions

Special Advisers

Will Straw
Spencer Thompson
Tom Hughes
Rachel Smethers
Jess Leigh
Rav Athwal
Daniel Harris
Emily Lynch

Treasury officials

Permanent Secretary – James Bowler
Second Permanent Secretary – Beth Russell
Second Permanent Secretary – Jim O'Neil
Chief Economic Advisor – Brian Bell
Director General, Public Spending – Conrad Smewing
Director General Growth and Productivity – Jessica Glover
Director General, Tax and Welfare – Will MacFarlane
Director, Fiscal – Steve Farrington
Director, Economics – Dan Gallagher
Director, Personal Tax, Welfare and Pensions – Laura Webster
Director, Public Spending – Johanna Harston
Co-Directors, Business and International Tax – Faith Quigley/Ruby Thompson
Director, Business and International Tax – Tim Power
Director, Enterprise and Growth – Stuart Glassborrow
Director, Strategy, Planning and Budget – Dharmesh Nayee
Director of Communications – David Pares
Deputy Director, General Expenditure Policy – Benjamin West
Deputy Director, Fiscal Statistics and Policy – Jenny Gray
Co-Deputy Directors, Macroeconomic Assessment – Victoria Ogden/Alison Massey
Deputy Director, Macroeconomic Coordination and Strategy – Tom Hemingway
Deputy Director, Personal Tax – Scarlett Graham
Deputy Director, Budget and Finance Bill – Oliver Haydon
Deputy Director, Labour Markets and Distributional Analysis – Nicholas Broadway
Deputy Director, Growth Strategy – Huw Leslie

Official preparing briefing (Economy forecast) x2
Official preparing briefing (Economy) x5
Official preparing briefing (Fiscal forecast) x4
Official preparing briefing (Fiscal policy) x3
Official preparing briefing (Spending forecast) x3
Official preparing briefing (Spending) x2
Official preparing briefing (Scorecard and costings) x5

Official preparing briefing (Policy and presentational) x2
Official preparing briefing (Tax strategy) x4
Press officer x2